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OXYGEN CRISIS

20 MARCH 2021

INDIA | 3,09,664 ACTIVE CASES | 1,60,927 DEATHS | 3.71 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

WORLD | 1,46,74,406 ACTIVE CASES | 28,41,527 DEATHS | 26.57 CRORE VACCINE DOSES

By the middle of March, the case trajectory, which is the seven-day average of new COVID-19 cases, had risen by 67 per cent across the country from the touching lows which saw less than 11,000 cases a day, just over a month ago. The plateauing trend in several states had replaced itself by a full-blown upward trajectory, marking a clear beginning of the next wave. Another pattern which emerged was the disproportionate rise in cases across the states. From the numbers at this point, five states appeared to have led the resurgence of the virus in the country where cases seemed to be rising twice as fast as the national average: Punjab, Maharashtra and Haryana. New Delhi and Madhya Pradesh followed with a significant gap in numbers. Punjab saw cases go up over 509 per cent from the deepest low point following the first wave—eight times the national average. Maharashtra saw the second highest resurgence of cases at 331 per cent from bottoming out after the first wave, closely followed by Haryana at a 302 per cent rise. While the tidal wave of cases in Punjab, Haryana and New Delhi could be attributed to the rolling crowds of protestors, Maharashtra’s rise was possibly driven by the Delta variant discovered in February.